Data Center News

Think Tank Pennsylvania

Tuesday, November 10, 2026

Amazon circles the biggest gas plant in the country

Amazon is in talks to build a data center campus next to the huge gas-fired power plant rising on the old Homer City coal site in Indiana County, about 50 miles east of Pittsburgh. Amazon Web Services (AWS) — Amazon's cloud-computing arm — confirmed the talks but said no deal is signed. The plant, Homer City Redevelopment, will produce 4.5 gigawatts of electricity when it opens in 2028, which could make it the largest gas-fired plant in the country. AWS has also filed a preliminary plan for 36 data-center buildings there, tabled by county planners in September after a packed public meeting.

https://www.datacenterdynamics.com/en/news/aws-eyes-potential-data-center-development-at-45gw-natural-gas-plant-in-pennsylvania/ (Data Center Dynamics)

Twelve proposals, six counties, 12.5 gigawatts of gas

A student research team has mapped 12 data-center proposals across six Southwestern Pennsylvania counties. FracTracker Alliance, an environmental research group, ran the sprint with four Pittsburgh student interns. At their highest stated sizes, the proposals would add about 12.5 gigawatts of gas-fired power — running around the clock, roughly three-quarters of all the electricity Pennsylvanians used in 2024. The report's message: project details are hard to find, approval timelines are compressed, developers ask officials to sign nondisclosure agreements, and local zoning codes do not even define a data center. Caution: FracTracker is an advocacy group; its figures are its own reading of filings and records.

https://fractracker.org/2026/10/southwestern-pennsylvania-data-center-proposals/ (FracTracker Alliance)

A 1-gigawatt campus on a former landfill — still just a concept

A developer is pitching a 1-gigawatt data-center campus with its own gas-fired power plant on a 549-acre former U.S. Steel landfill in Elizabeth Township, Allegheny County. Layouts run from 11 to 28 two-story buildings. No formal plans or permits have been filed, and the township has not endorsed the project. Developer Tim Hendricks projects up to $125 million in tax revenue, but no taxing body prepared those figures. Township commission President Josh Walls says the township is still evaluating the idea; a town hall was held October 13.

https://www.rustwire.com/rust-belt/elizabeth-township-data-center-plans-raise-questions-about-scale-power-and-oversight/ (RustWire)

How the midterms could reshape data-center policy

The November 3 midterm results could reshape data-center policy, the Brookings Institution argues. Dozens of cities and counties voted on data-center bans or zoning limits, and many passed by more than three-quarters of the vote. The levers ahead include tougher permitting rules, longer moratoriums, a stronger federal Ratepayer Protection Act, limits on building data centers without local approval, repeal of sales-tax exemptions, and an end to nondisclosure agreements. Counter-pressure remains: a bipartisan permitting bill may still move, and the Trump administration's voluntary developer-pays order could become mandatory. Caution: commentary with a national scope, not a Pennsylvania story.

https://www.brookings.edu/articles/how-the-2026-midterms-could-reshape-data-center-policy (Brookings)

ONE TO WATCH

Cato reads the midterms three ways: AI disinformation never became the election-disrupting problem many feared; data centers were on the ballot — 21 of the measures that passed to restrict them were in Ohio — though AI ranked low as voters' top issue; and with Democrats taking both chambers of Congress, federal AI rules may stall, pushing the action to state legislatures, where over 1,000 AI bills were introduced in two sessions. Caution: Cato is a libertarian think tank.
https://www.cato.org/blog/3-things-2026-midterm-election-tells-us-about-ai-likely-future-ai-policy (Cato Institute)

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